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EDITOR's NOTE

"Sometimes when I read and write, though the experience and realization that solidify into language may be incomplete and lagged, I feel certain words and knowledge 'setting' in my mind like a surprise present..."

However clichéd it may seem to say, the richness reading lls a reader with is unbounded and rewarding. No matter the content, a reader loads their mind with deliberation, and this process itself, I believe, is not only educational but also foundational for an individual.

The quote at the beginning of this letter is from a 22nd waver, who recently entered KMLA with high hopes of receiving more of those "presents." Unfortunately, I cannot confidently say her view is shared with the school's overall sentiment. Many students don't even have time to read, except homework assignments and mandatory reading materials. Students no longer carry books into the library; they carry their laptops and textbooks for homework. 66.1% of students who were asked the question "Do you think the school's reading-encouraging programs help you to read for the sake of learning and enriching your mind?" answered no. Also, the majority of the student viewed the Monday reading class as ineffective and not properly functioning. (121 students answered the question.)

In this edition of Minjok Herald, we attempt to add a small helping hand for the revival. We hope to tap into your childhood or obsession you had over a novel's character, and let you share the zap of passion you felt before. We will reveal the hidden fandoms at KMLA, and introduce the great library system that many ignore and fail to use.

I hope when that 22nd waver graduates after two years, she can say, "The present was for all students to share; the act of sharing itself enriched the whole process and drove me to reach for more."

Jung Sang-Min
Editor-in-Chief
May 22nd, 2017



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SNAPSHOT













SNAPSHOT

Change in the KMLA Admissions Process



From October 20th to October 23rd, the admissions process for the new KMLAians took place. Last year, several changes were made throughout the whole process.

One of the biggest changes was about time. In the previous years, students had four interviews, spending 20 minutes for each. Last year, KMLA has separated the interview into five parts and allocated 15 minutes for each. Therefore, the total amount of time has decreased from 80 minutes to 75 minutes. Why did KMLA make such a change? Mr. Kim Seong Woo, who is the manager of the administration office said, "In last year's interview, we have selected 2.5 times more students from the quota, which has increased than the past. Therefore, we lacked time to examine each student as long as before. This is why we diminished the interview time."

Another important change happened in the subjects of interview. KMLA initially tested students in mainly four parts: Korean, Math, English, and Personality with Social Studies or Science. However, they divided the last part into two and renamed each subject as follows:

"We would not test knowledge, but how they think"

Comprehension of Korean (Korean), Mathematical Thinking (Math), Practical English (English), Happy School Life (Personality). Also, KMLA has integrated social subjects into one. Mr. Kim said, "We would not test knowledge, but how they think. As today's society focuses on the integration of knowledge, we decided not to divide social subjects."

Lastly, an examination of physical strength was done not on the track but on the entrance to the campus. Until last year, all the applicants were required to run laps around the soccer field. However, the school found out that the amount of lead in the track exceeded the standard. Thus, the school banned the usage of the track and decided to have the physical examination on the road. Although the location was changed, the distance students need to run remained the same.

KMLA hopes these changes have positive effects and looks forward to greeting future wavers.

Junior writer
Yang Hyeon-Jun

The School Uniform, *Hanbok*, Changes

"The new uniform looks wonderful, having a sense of modernity added to the original uniform, giving it a formal and refined impression," said 21st waver Yim Na-Ri. In May 2016, the Uniform Special Committee, consisting of three students, parents, and teachers, was formed to change the KMLA uniform.

The Uniform Committee held numerous meetings to discuss the uniform bidding since last semester. While the teachers of the committee emphasized the identity of hanbok, along with the characteristics of KMLA, students focused on the practical side. Parents made sure that the uniform does not miss out the aesthetic quality as well.

The new uniform was designed by Kim Ye-Jin. She donated her talents to spread the beauty of hanbok through KMLA. She said in a Yonhap news article that she tried to emphasize the beauty of traditional culture of Korea along with modernity to design the hanbok in accordance with the students' preference. The students of the Uniform Committee conducted a survey via Facebook chats to analyze students' preferences. Their response was reflected in the display of new designs held in the Dasan Hall. The display was held for 10 days, and students voted for their favorite designs.

Other than that the hanbok was aesthetically impressive and the prices went down because the uniforms would be ready-made; the original school uniform was expensive because it was customized for each student. Thus, with the new system, students can now wear uniforms made with better fabric without the heavy pricing.

Yet, 20th waver Cho Sung-Min, a member of the Uniform Committee, revealed his complaints that the students in the Uniform Committee did not have much say in the decision-making process. He blamed the designer's obstinacy and the parents' fickleness. "The opinions of teachers and students were oftentimes disregarded and sometimes looked down upon."

Some students expressed their dissatisfaction with the color of the new hanbok, commenting it lacks the traditional look of hanbok. A student noted that some of the new uniforms look like Western Navy clothes. On the other hand, some students such as 21th waver Cho Seong-Hyun rather felt that the designer reinterpreted the traditional hanbok into a more appropriate, modern form.

This change has still an ongoing contentious debate. Surely such a difference in opinion was anticipated, like any changes the school has gone through. Nonetheless, the difference in the value of tradition and modernity of hanbok will always remain as something to discuss even until the school uniform changes again.

Junior writer
Tak Ga-Heon

"This change has still an ongoing contentious debate."



Great Success of the 6th Minjok Music Festival

"We started preparing for the Minjok Music Concert about a month ago. Preparing for the concert was really painstaking because we had to skip about four independent studying periods a week, but still had to do all the school assignments at the same time. On the other hand, thanks to this period, we could build more friend relationships with each other. Furthermore, it was quite meaningful to participate in introducing our school to the public," said 21st waver Yoon Gang-Hyun.

The 6th Minjok Music Concert was successfully held in November 13th. Most students were satisfied with their performances, and everyone seems to agree the memories and the experience earned are priceless. In fact, this concert was a precious event not only for students in KMLA but also freshmen who entered KMLA this February, because this concert provided the ever first opportunity for them to actually witness the true value of KMLA: a school that they have dreamed for. It was an opportunity for the newcomers to see that KMLA is truly a place where students do not limit their activities to desks and chairs but venture out to explore the dream they grew in their minds.

The concert took place in the Hall of Kyung Hee University, called the Grand Peace Palace, for the first time in KMLA History. In the past years, the school rented the Hall in Sang Myung University. However, the new and former Headmaster wished the students to perform in a grander and more luxurious stage. Thus, the school decided to move the location to the biggest stage in the country: Grand Peace Palace. The concert hall is well-known for holding important events in South Korea, including numerous singing TV shows and major film festival like the Blue Dragon Film Festival. However, there were some





complaints from the students that the stage was too big; the size of the stage itself gave the impression of being empty, giving a lot of concern to dance clubs and Orchestras. The great sound system the university provided and the impressive lighting, which was clearly differentiated from the past location, helped to cope with this problem. Nonetheless, the school is planning to move back to their initial location, Sang Myung University, this year.

Regardless of the controversy surrounding the location, the effort and time students put into their performance was evident. Dae Chi Ta, the Korean traditional marching band, started off the concert with their booming shouts and their own arranged version of the original melody. Fathers, for the first time, participated in the parents' choir, which was originally named the mothers' choir. The choir was able to have fuller and more diverse melodies with the new tenors hitting the bass notes. Students paid their contribution back with a choir of their own decorating the finale. The last melody the choir sang was our school song, following the tradition of ending the concert with the new coming students, current attending waves, parents, and teachers singing the song and reminding themselves about the true meaning of KMLA: "Let us study not for the sake of personal gain but for the sake of learning itself to become leaders of the world."

Like Yoon Gang-Hyun said in the interview, students practiced excessively for the concert. Though the process of preparing was challenging, sometimes even painful, the endurance paid off with everyone returning to their home with a big smile.

Junior writer
Bae Sang-Kyu

VANK, Inviting Its Leader for a Lecture



On November 22th, Park Ki-Tae, the head of VANK, visited Korean Minjok Leadership Academy to give a lecture with the theme of "Small Giants that Change the World." VANK is the abbreviation of Voluntary Agency Network of Korea, a cyber organization that started in January 1999, which publicizes Korea and Koreans accurately through various methods such as e-mails.

KMLA VANK is a club that discusses the diverse problems, such as the Dokdo controversy or the comfort women problem existing in Korea and tries raise awareness on such issues. 20th waver Kim Jung-Min, the head of the club, tried to book Mr. Park for almost a year, and the lecture on November 22th was the result of his hard work. He stated that though there were many hardships in the process, he was proud to providing many students with the opportunity to listen to the meaningful lecture. "I had sent official e-mails and eventually received his personal phone number. Though there were conflicts with the school related to financial issues, with the help of Korean history teacher Mr. Oh Byeong-Mun and big willingness from Mr. Park, I was able to succeed holding the lecture in the second semester."

Most of Mr. Park's lecture was about how VANK earned the prestige that it has now and its achievements from the members all over the world. Before the introduction of VANK, he briefly mentioned himself and his relationships with KMLA. He had visited KMLA ten years before, which was the momentum for the development of the VANK@KMLA club. Mr. Park expressed his delight in interacting with KMLA students. The PPT slides and the speech he had prepared showed the main problems of misunderstandings of South Korea of the world. Then, Mr. Park showed pictures about the changes VANK members had accomplished through their efforts. The examples included things such as the addition of the name East Sea in English textbooks and official websites, making a website that educated people about the Japanese colonial era and the damage Koreans received, and the correct description of the South Korean history expressed in official websites.

Out of various accomplishments, one particular thing Mr. Park was proud of was the production of a world map and a map of East Asia. Each map had beautiful designs of cultural heritage and flowers respectively, with the name East Sea and Dokdo imprinted. Mr. Park explained that VANK had delivered these maps to schools all over the world until now, reaching ten million copies. His goal was to distribute these maps all over the world to inform people about the accurate name of the sea between South Korea and Japan.

VANK's lecture was a huge success. Even though many students were tired due to the Minjok Harmony Day held during lunch, most students participated well in listening to the lecture and asking questions. "I really liked the lecture. It gave me a vision about what I should do for the country in the future," said 21st waver Gwak Min-Gi who listened to the lecture. Mr. Oh, who gave his support, also expressed his satisfaction and his hopes to the students. "After listening to the lecture, I found out that students are only thinking about huge, showy actions to do. I hope the students can see their small actions can also bring about change."

Junior writer
Park Sang-Yoon

Spectrum of Choice in Course Registration Gradually Shrinks



Course registration, is often identified as one of KMLA's specialties. Commonly mentioned as a key characteristic, course registration has been a significant element of our academic lives, until now; excessive compulsory modules are continuously encroaching on free modules, corroding availability for students to organize their plans freely. This tendency has been maintained and maximized in recent years.

The issue that brought up this debate more recently was enforced registration of two-hour physical education, starting from the 20th wavers, for both junior and senior years. The choices given to the students before this change were two hours of music, art, or physical education. On the other hand, 20th wavers are the first to have two hours of physical education as mandatory and have music and art, in combination, decreased into a single hour choice. Mr. Kim Tae-wan explains that the decision was made by the school administration, reflecting the Department of Education's policy to have 10 units of PE, where fifty percent deviation is allowed only for autonomous private high schools.

Complaints have been raised among both students and teachers. Students were dissatisfied that physical education takes their chances of registering freely chosen subjects in the H module, which is mainly individual research. Another important factor is that excessive PE might exhaust the students in addition to the morning exercise and sports club activity. For these reasons, according to the quick poll taken by the 21st legislative council, the vast majority of the students were against this new plan. Some teachers in the music and art department were also unhappy for minimizing the module given to them into a single hour, which is not enough for teaching a subject thoroughly. Reflecting this argument, recently, two hours of art or music classes are now mandatory for 21st wavers, but 20th wave curriculum remains the same.

The 21st legislative council reported these complaints to Mr. Kang Mun-Keun, the head of the Academic Administration Division last semester. However, his answer was that the curriculum issue had already been fixed even before the entrance of each wavers and already had been approved by the Department of Education. Separate to this, In order to disprove the rumor among the students that this change was enforced by the Department of Education, he added: "Still, this decision was made by the school members solely."

The former Headmaster, during the meeting with the 21st Legislative Council, commented that students shouldn't be able to "intervene" on the school's decision especially in the field of curriculum issue, since the school administration, as educators, should be able to enforce certain ratios of study to the students.

Luckily, however, thanks to the effort of the 22nd Student Council, a compromise of utilizing Wednesdays' 7th and 8th period as a new H module has been suggested, but there is still no change in the excessive mandatory physical education modules. Although the school used to remain unwilling in accepting the majority opinion, there seems to be some possibility of managing and searching for better, possible, and realistic alternatives.

Senior writer
Cho Sung-Min

FE

We read for various reasons—to escape the harsh reality into an ideal land, to learn from the lessons of those who are wiser than us, to look for information, or just for the sake of reading itself. Students are especially expected read a large quantity of high quality books. With KMLA's library packed full with books, it is natural that the students are expected to read. But within tightly packed schedules, reading might be a hard task for students. So why should we read more books? And how can we read more while playing out our harsh schedules? What books should we read, and how can we enjoy reading? The feature crew of Minjok Herald introduces its readers to its one and only reading guide for KMLA students.


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The Top Three Library Systems That We Should Become Friendlier With

The library provides a number of useful services for students, but the reality is that few students know about them and actually use them. Considering that quite a lot of the library budget is used to provide such services, it would be a waste if students didn't use such systems. Here are the top three library systems that students should definitely make more use of.



1. Requesting Books

When you are looking for a certain book, first look it up at the library website (http://lib.minjok.hs.kr), which provides an online catalog service. If the library does not own the book you are looking for, request for it through the library website. You can request foreign books as well as domestic books. Go to the library website> My page> 자료구입신청, and write the title, author, publisher, publishing date, and price of the book you're looking for. The library orders books on a monthly basis. It usually takes about 10 days for domestic purchases and 3 weeks for foreign purchases to arrive at the library after ordering.

2. Inter-Library Loan Service and Copying Service

The library offers an Inter-Library Loan service and Copying service which provides access to material the library does not have. Students can create an ID at www.riss.kr and enter their institute as "민족사관고등학교." Once the librarian verifies the student's ID as a member of the institute, students are free to request books or copies of documents.

This system is very convenient for students who are researching subjects that do not have many related books in the school library. Furthermore, the school pays for these services, so students need not worry about payment.



3. Access to Databases

The school network allows students to access journals online at the Korean Studies Information Service System (http://kiss.kstudy.com) or DBpia (http://www.dbpia.co.kr). It also provides access to a number of foreign e-journals, including the Scientific American (http://www.sciamdigital.com/), American Journal of Physics (http://www.aapt.org), Physics Teacher (http://scitation.aip.org/tpt/), PMLA (http://www.mlajournals.org/loi/pmla), and more. As long as they're using the school network, students can use these websites freely. Only PMLA requires an ID and password, which you can learn from the librarian.



The library has more things in stock for us than we might think. Before complaining about lack of books, or difficulties in finding research subjects, how about using these library services? Students would certainly be able to gain much more just by knowing and using these systems efficiently.

Junior writer
Yang Soo-Jung

If You're Going to "Waste" Time, Do so at the Library

"Good morning, KMLA family. Today we don't have class council, so you may use your eighth period freely."

A booming cheer meets the head of the legislative council every time this announcement is made. As soon as the bell signals the end of the seventh period, students rush past corridors in search of a place to spend their free time. Arguably the most desired among these locations is the school library; understandably so, as the fast wifi coupled with a comfortable seat and table is perfect for any activity. Thanks to such high demand, if any faculty member in KMLA doesn't need to urge students to use their designated space for show, it would be our librarian, Mr. Kim Dong-Myoung

This scenario of academically passionate students spending their free time in the library sounds great. But are students actually using the library? Or is it merely the chairs and tables that the students are taking advantage of? Mr. Kim is disappointed to admit the status quo looks a lot like the latter. The Mangyung library, an unparalleled school library aiming to provide the ideal location for students' intellectual growth, is making its descent towards a mundane study hall at an alarming rate. According to Mr. Kim and the head of the Department of Library Service, book purchase requests and the number of borrowed books have been in constant decline.

"It's not the students that are to blame for the drop in library resource usage," says Mr. Kim. "It's the system. Ten years back, prestigious colleges in Korea selected KMLA students on the basis of extracurricular achievement. Since class rank was evaluated on a level playing field with non-selective high schools, our students had to strive to take advantage of the library's resources



and distinguish themselves from their peers." Yet the increase of selective schools has made grades an important factor in evaluating students, as numbers are easier to compare than "intellectual interest," changing the priority of students accordingly. Mr. Kim admitted that current KMLA students do not fall behind their seniors in terms of academic capability, but inevitably lack the passion for their studies of interest. Instead, they are lethargic from the pressure that classes give them, that Mr. Kim thinks asking them to take advantage of the library books is too ideal of a request.

Yet we all know that inside the library lie jewels that we are missing out on. So what can we do to seek intellectual growth in the library in the midst of the Korean college game, where class rank prevails over anything else?

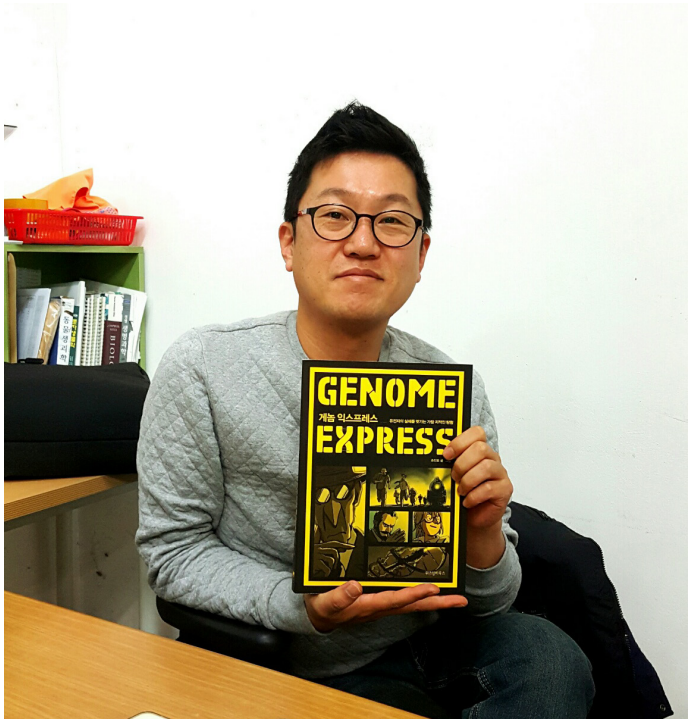
Mr. Kim proposes a solution: "If you're going to 'waste' time, do so at the library." With much work follows a desire to squander some time for leisure and step away from reality. The sad truth is that we waste that time with our noses pushed against smartphone screens. What we don't realize is that the library offers leisure that helps us find new worlds and perhaps develop a passion that we could not possibly find in our classes. So the next time class council is cancelled, head to the library. Instead of laughing at Facebook posts or playing games, immerse yourself in a good book or two. If our seniors found intellectual growth in the Mangyung library, there's no reason we shouldn't be able to do the same.

Junior writer
Jung Chan-Young

Reading off the List: Books that Teachers Recommend

Students of Korean Minjok Leadership Academy are well aware of the reading class program. Once a week, students join their teachers to learn, read, and talk about books. There is a list of books that are used for KMLA's student-teacher reading program, which teachers have selected and recommended. However, the world has much more knowledge and information to provide through reading. And there are many more books students should be inspired to read than those on the recommendation list.

To find such books, Minjok Herald visited biology teacher Mr. Choi Jin-Ho. Mr. Choi Jin-Ho is famous for recently publishing the book *Genome Express*, which has been established as "book of the month" by the Publication Industry Promotion Agency of Korea.



MH: What book do you recommend for students of KMLA?

I have a book that comes to mind. This has to be one of my favorite sub-genres; psychological science fiction. It was also an inspiration for me to pursue writing as well. *Flowers for Algernon* by Daniel Keyes is in the format of Charlie's diary. From grammar to spelling, everything is made to give the impression of reading an actual diary. Charlie, who is mentally disabled, tells how a brain operation increases his IQ and changes his life. That's an interesting concept, right? This book explores the nature of intelligence, the effects of intelligence on the way you see others and the world around you, as well as social attitudes towards people with mental problems. KMLA students will definitely enjoy themselves reading this.

MH: We understand you successfully published a book. Could you explain what motivated you to do so?

Ever since I was young I had a strong interest in movies and comics that tickled the boundaries of scientific imagination. After graduating college I read a lot of books about science and encountered the interesting side of science. Since then I had the dream of writing a science book that isn't hard and cold. I wanted to write book that is just as emotional and interesting as literature books and stimulates the imagination of the reader. I've written two books until now and am flattered to know that people are reading and showing attention. It's very fun and meaningful and I don't plan on stopping even though it's not easy. I want to write the best scientific graphic novels, ones that have interesting story, deep contents, and helpful scientific information.

MH: Not many of us have written a book before and we are curious; what process did you go through to write, draw, and publish the book?

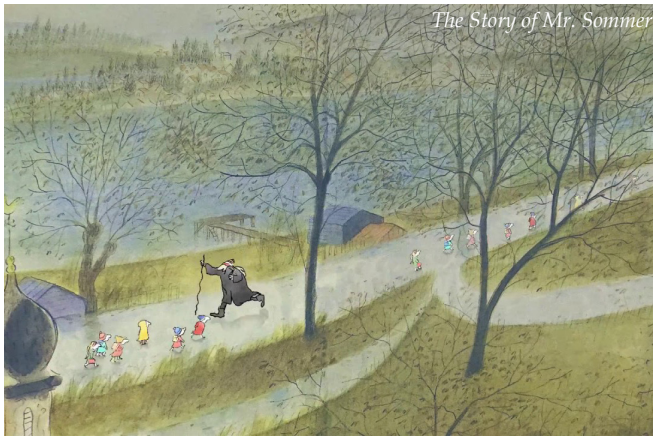
The most important thing is to find someone willing to publish your work. There are many publishing companies but it is pretty difficult to find a place to publish your work. Luckily, I managed to find a publisher that helped my novel *Amazing Gravity* be published in 2012. I think my concept of graphic novels conveying science was one of the reasons I stood out, and having a book already published helped me publish my second book, too. But publishing still requires a lot of effort. After all, publishing companies will publish your work only if it's promising. In my case, I would spend every extra moment I had to work on the plot, and went to a café during the weekends to draw.

MH: What book do you recommend for students of KMLA?

Mr. Doo-Hyun Lee

I recommend *The Story of Mr. Sommer* by Patrick Süskind. The book is about a man reflecting on his life and the impact he received from Mr. Sommer, a mysterious man who wanders around. The narrator captures the experiences anyone can have as a child. This was originally written by a German author so it has a peculiar fairytale-like feeling and even has illustrations. It makes people think about what life is in a relaxed manner. I think students should use their spare time to read this book at least once in your life.

I came across this book by pure coincidence when I was in middle school. Then I read it a couple more times in college. I was able to comprehend much more of the contents then. I even gave it as a gift to a person whom I liked. It's been almost ten years since I had this book. That's how much of a good book I think it is, for it helps people reflect their lives.



Mrs. So-Hee Hwang

When you look at modern online bookstores, feminism-related books sell well to readers in their twenties and thirties, so I think it would be a good idea if KMLA students read those kinds of books as well. I think that it is important to follow the leading trend of the generation through reading. I think it is also important that students read more books in general: I really feel like students nowadays read a lot less than they used to.



Ms. So-Jung Min

I really don't read a lot of books, uh…. Well, there is this book: *Mandala* by Sung-Dong Kim. That is a book about Buddhism, and I read it while I was in high school and felt like wandering. I hope that any student who feels unsure of themselves reads this book and gets back on track.



It was interesting, to say the least. All in all, we at Minjok Herald could see that each teacher made diverse recommendations based on their beliefs and lifestyles. What they said told a lot about themselves. But in the end, the common message the teachers tried to tell us was to read more books and learn more about the world. We sincerely hope we managed to relay this message to you.

Junior writer
Ahn Tae-Gyu, Lee Ho-Jung

The Future of the Mangyung Library: Feedback from the Librarian

As KMLA students we've probably all been to the school library, whether it was for a last-minute emergency print job that needed to be done, or because we hoped to do something productive during empty periods. Having won the presidential award several times, our school library is in fact one of the best high school libraries in Korea. But, still there are improvements to be made and of course certain limitations as well.

The feature crew of Minjok Herald has suggested the digitalization of the library as one such improvement, and discussed the matter with the librarian, Mr. Kim Dong Myeong.

Suggestion 1: AR system

The AR system is a system that requires students to take an online quiz after they read a book to guarantee that they read the book. When a student passes the quiz, the AR scores are recorded in the student record. The Feature Crew thought the AR system, which is used in schools in the US, would motivate students to read more books.

However, Mr. Kim showed suspicion towards AR system for many reasons. First, a student is not guaranteed to have read the book by passing the quiz. The current system, in which a student has to write an essay about the book and get approval from the teacher who recommended the book, is more credible. But more importantly, the purpose of AR is uncertain. If AR points are written on the student record, they are relatively meaningless for the international field. Plus, Korean universities don't admit AR scores as a credit, so it would not be a good incentive for the domestic field.

Suggestion 2: Activation of eBooks

Currently, the digital services the library provides are databases and E-journals. The databases are JSTOR, DVP, KISS (professional English-written academic papers), Britannica (encyclopedia), PMLA, etc. E-journals are freely available to students by using school IPs. Students frequently use e-journals for research purposes. The case is different for books, however.

An individual can simply buy and read an eBook from his or her PC, but the library has to buy one eBook, which would be available to all students. If everyone can access one eBook, Kindle Stores (Amazon) cannot last for long. Therefore, the library eBook system should allow only one person to borrow one eBook, and mandate him or her to return it within a given amount of days online.

But there are two more problems that Mr. Kim explained. First, for Korean books, the format isn't universal. KYOBO and YES24 have different formats, so the library would need eBook systems for each of them. And secondly, students are relying too heavily on digital information. What should be urgent for the future global leaders may be a paper book, and the patience and the effort to invest a lot of time to find the information they need. Cost problems are negligible compared to this big question: Do we have to promote the digitalization of books?

From the conversation with the librarian, the Feature Crew could understand the true meaning of a library. Sure, the library has problems, and there are several ways in which it can be developed. Digitalization may or may not be one such solution. But what matters is that, digitalized or not, students show great attention to reading and to the library.

Junior writer
Lee Ji-Yin, Jun Hyung-Joon

THE SILENT PAGE-TURNERS of KMLA

Read, Read, Read. We've all probably been drilled through this repeatedly over and over by teachers, parents and just about anyone who gives advice. But the truth is that it is hard to squeeze a book into your bookcase when you only have 1mm of extra space for it to fit in. In KMLA our bookshelves are dominated by our bulky brick-like textbooks and workbooks that sometimes there is just not enough room to accommodate anything else. Reading amongst the packed calendar of KMLA takes pain-staking effort. The minimum reading time KMLA students get is the one period per week during the morning reading classes, but it can be hard not to treat the books as a pillow rather than a source of brain enrichment. Perhaps that is why one of the awards that is respected amongst the students is the best reader award. I find myself saying the same old three words again, but this time with the letter "e" in front of each "read." Let us meet the silent page turners of KMLA

There are not that many users of E-books, but often times we can see someone with a kindle reading while eating at lunch during the few minutes of *honjeong*. They read silently. Their pages don't make any noise. Minjok Herald has interview 21st waver Kim Jae-ho and Lee Tae-Hyeon to hear their stories.

MH: Why do you use E-books?

I use e-books because they're so much more convenient than paper books. They're light and can hold a whole library load of books in them. Most of the books come at a discount; some even for free. Another benefit is the backlight which takes away the necessity to bring a lamp if you want to read in bed at night. And well... I just like reading and oftentimes when you carry a book and especially if it's thick, people will think you're nerdy. The iPad-like appearance of e-books, I think, attract less attention than holding a thick paper book in your hand. But at the same time, I have teachers who confuse my e-book reader with iPads and want to give me computer violation.

MH: How are E-books effective in getting you to read at KMLA?

Well, since you can carry it almost anywhere, the shortest slips of time can become an opportunity to read. By cramming in a few pages here and there you eventually find yourself surprised by how you got through a book just by utilizing some of that extra time.

MH: Do you really read that much with your E-book?

Ok, I do admit that I don't always read avidly. But, having an e-book reader definitely helped me utilize my time better. You're more likely to read a book if you have one than when you don't.



We all stand upon the pile of books we've read. The height of the mountain pile allows us a different view of the world. Though there may not be a wide enough space on our bookshelves for books other than textbooks, perhaps a thin E-book reader could help us squeeze in some extra books.

Junior writer
Jun Hyung-Joon

Securing the Readership of KMLA

There is one more thing, other than the sheer distaste towards Mondays and grueling routine of morning exercise and morning ceremony, that greets KMLA students at the start of a week. It is the Monday-morning reading class. Primarily organized by the librarian, in this program, students are given a variety of books and teachers to choose from. The students are then required to choose one specific book to read with a teacher for eight classes. The purpose of this class is to get students to read quality books, even in the hectic schedule KMLA has for all of its students. Unfortunately, the classes are not all being carried out properly, as often times motivation is lost and class time is not secured.



The lack of enthusiasm in reading classes is a chronic phenomenon that has plagued the classes for a long time. Although there are a handful of classes that are filled with rich discussions and fluent presentations, many of the reading classes are wasted with Monday morning naps, general lectures, and meaningless writing assignments. Nobody in specific is to blame, but it is evident that everybody must step up to energize the classes. The teachers must primarily adhere to the class syllabus that is posted in the intranet. Then, in the cases of teachers who do not change their book for over two sessions, they should be advised to do so. It would be a good idea to employ a system of rotation of two books for every two sessions, as some teachers already are doing. The more specific parts of the teaching methods cannot be interfered with, but some measures should definitely be taken to make these classes a challenge for the teachers, in order for students to trail along eagerly. The student's part, then, is to follow the teachers properly. It is the role of the teachers to set up an encouraging environment in which students could perform. But without students' participation, even the greatest curriculums could all crumble to ruins.

Yet a bigger problem lurks in the sense of class time. Officially, the first period of Monday, which is the morning ceremony, is supposed to end before 9:20 am. That way, students can arrive to their reading classes by 9:30. Because reading class is an official class, 50 minutes of class time must be secured. However, the ceremony tends to end late, even at 9:35 am, taking up almost 10 to 15 minutes of class time. Many teachers have expressed their disappointment with such tardiness: Mr. Kim Tae Wan has called it a "blatant discrimination and disrespect towards reading classes." Of course, the morning ceremony is an important start to the week, but it should not hinder the official class time of the next period.

These problems surrounding Monday morning reading classes can be solved, just with more care towards the fundamentals of the class. The importance of these classes to a KMLA student is colossal. In a life void of thorough reading done for pleasure, this time of the week is like an oasis that refreshes students' mind. And it would be awful to see such a valuable experience get endangered. Both teachers and students will have to cooperate eagerly to muddle out of this crisis.

Senior writer
Han Ji-Min

Introducing the Most Popular KMLA Book Fandoms

Although KMLA students have a hard time finding spare time to read, there still are a lot of avid readers who especially love certain books. We call such groups of people "fandoms." Members of fandoms usually show special affection towards a certain book or series of books, and do much more than just reading. Fandoms go on to create artworks based on book series or characters, write stories using characters, plots, or settings from the books, and basically know everything they can about the book series they love.

So what are some popular book fandoms in KMLA? The feature crew of Minjok Herald conducted a survey to find out a few of the biggest book fandoms in KMLA.



1. Harry Potter

Coming in first place with an overwhelming number of votes is the *Harry Potter* series by J. K. Rowling. Harry Potter fans are called "Potterheads." The most common fandom activities are sorting out Hogwarts houses, by which characters within the novel are divided at their magical school. Potterheads go through online tests to find out what wand they would carry as wizards, or to find out their patronuses, which are defenders of the soul, and dress up in Hogwarts school uniforms at Halloween.

One Potterhead of KMLA says: "despite being a fantasy series, the Harry Potter world's setting has a lot of holes. Imagining what might have happened in such empty spaces is what makes me a Potterhead."

2. Sherlock Holmes

Sherlock Holmes, Arthur Conan Doyle's detective who first appeared in 1887, is still adored to this day. The Sherlock Holmes fandom was one of the first book fandoms in the Western fandoms, derived from the mourning of the detective's death. The fandom is often called "Sherlockians." Fandom activity is centered around writing second-hand fiction, or fanfiction, mostly bringing Sherlock back to life after his death.

A fan of this detective says that his attractiveness is in that he is a flat character. The Sherlockian explains that unlike round characters that are fully developed, Sherlock is flat and serves a perfect narrative purpose. The flatness of character also provides for possibility of fans to imagine him as a round character, outside of his cases.

3. Percy Jackson

Let's admit it: we all have read the Greek and Roman mythology at least once. The *Percy Jackson* series by Rick Riordan is based on the premise that such gods are real and alive in today's American culture. The story is centered around the protagonist Percy Jackson, a son of the sea god Poseidon.

Fans of Percy Jackson say that the catch of the series is in the idea that the characters are the children of such gods. The fandom activity starts off with deciding which god would be one's parent: much like the sorting of houses in the Harry Potter fandom. Fans enjoy themselves making quizzes that would determine which god's traits one has the most, as there is no official sorting algorithm for the fandom.

Other popular fandoms include the Narnian fandom and Lord of the Rings fandom. The most popular series were mostly of the fantasy genre, indicating that perhaps KMLA students need a place to escape to: a magical land where there are no stress of homework or university admissions.

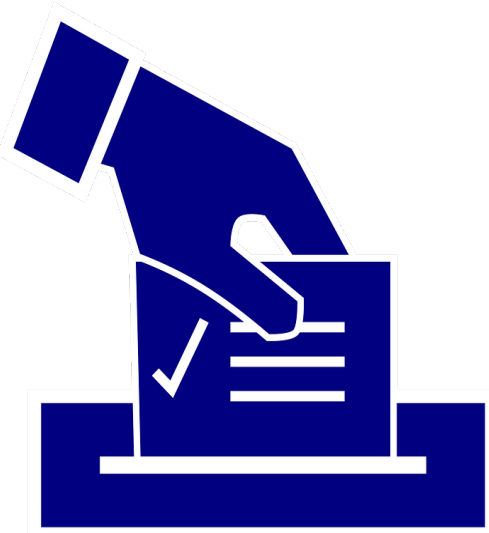
Senior writer
Kim Hee-Jin

Sole Candidate Election: What Should We Do?

Recently the 22nd Student Council has been elected. In this election, all the 10th graders were sole candidates. This was not the first time; in fact, the number of elections with sole candidates is increasing. The issue of how to elect a sole candidate is now being debated upon.

According to current school regulation, it guarantees the sole candidate a place in the Student Council. During the 22nd Student Council election, the 21st board of election stated that the electorates could choose to not support a sole candidate by abstaining one's vote. Yet, abstained votes will not change the result of the election; a sole candidate will always get elected. Thus, as the number of sole candidates increased, some suggested changing the election process to a one that will include a way for electorates to oppose a sole candidate.

The meaning of opposition and abstention is clearly different. The implication of abstained votes is either an expression of political neutrality or distrust of the whole election process. Opposing votes, on the other hand, express direct disagreement with a specific candidate. However, when there is only one candidate, the electorates are not provided with the choice of rejecting the candidate in the current system. In other words, even if there is not a single person who supports a candidate, s/he will be part of the Student Council, representing the student body.



The Student Council considered changing the election regulation and allowing the voters to reject a candidate even if it is a sole candidate election.

"The students should ponder upon the idea of lengthening one's term of service. "

Then, in order for the sole candidate to be elected, one would have to receive the majority of the votes. Such method will ensure that the candidate has the justification and the capability of representing the student body. However, it also opens up a possibility of leaving certain positions in Student Council to be left empty, when a sole candidate fails to receive the majority of the vote. Thus, changing the election process itself also holds its shortcoming.

Though having more candidates is the perfect solution to this issue, it is highly impractical to simply pray and wish for the best. The students should ponder upon the idea of lengthening one's term of service. The one semester term system of KMLA is highly unusual, compared to Western schools. The initial purpose of having such a system was because everyone wanted to become a leader. By shortening the term, the school ensured as many students as possible had the experience of being the representative of the student body. However, the current trend hints that such a purpose is lost and that there is need to find a new system. Radical it may seem, but the students must concede that our system is not the norm but a peculiar one in the eyes of other schools.

Junior writer
Ko Eun-Ji

Growing Doubts on the Penalty Point System

The Student Code of KMLA stipulates that students should participate in special training every time their penalty points reach 20, 40, or 60 points, and when the penalty points add up to 80 points, the student should be expelled. As the year of 2016 slowly reached its end, managing one's penalty points became quite an important issue for many students.

For the past months, some students were on the verge of receiving 80 or more penalty points. The Division of Student Affairs expressed much concern for this situation, and the Director of Student Affairs soon told the students that the school regulations would strictly be executed without exceptions. However, as the number of students who had their penalty points circling around 80 points did not reduce, doubts on the penalty point system itself grew rapidly.

Primarily, the penalty point system was made to discourage the students from committing inappropriate actions, but now, a penalty point or two no longer is a strong whip that can keep the students under control; they always have the opportunity to cancel out such penalty points through cleaning teachers' offices and receiving award points. A 10th grader student said, "In some recent cases, some students don't fix their actions after receiving penalty points. They just clean more to make up with award points. We need a better plan."

According to the conversation the Student Council had with the Headmaster on November 13th, he stated, "I totally agree [with the point that penalty points are not efficiently improving student's behavior]. Wrongdoings should be fixed. And pedagogically, it is shown that a carrot is better at achieving such goal, compared to a whip. After I came here, I told the faculty quite frequently that the ultimate purpose of education is to properly guide the students, not to punish them." Like the former Headmaster, many believe that the penalty point system is too much focused on the punishment itself, as shown in the expulsion regulation for students over 80 penalty points.

Many also argue that the magnitude of a violation and the penalty point are not proportional. For example, one 21st waver states, "We get eight points for curfew violation, but we only receive five for lying. Doesn't everyone agree that lying is a much bigger crime than violating curfew?"

"If any injustice or problem is witnessed, the teachers highly encourage anyone to make a change"

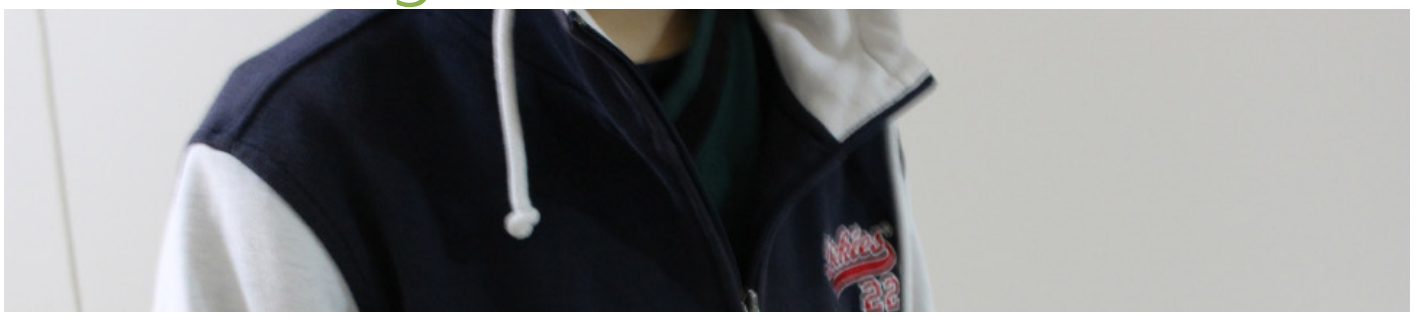
On the other hand, the school also has a reason of its own for such rules to be made. The number of penalty points assigned for each violation is not a random number; there is always some reason behind it, although the justifications of the reasons are always debatable. The school highly encourages the students to change the rules through the Legislative Council if they witness a problem. A teacher from the Division of Student Affairs stated, "KMLA always opens doors to students who want to change the school. If any injustice or problem is witnessed, the teachers highly encourage anyone to make a change, so it won't happen again." Not only by words, but both students and the school should try hard to overcome this distorted but influential system with much debate and action.



Every Thursday, student court is held in the auditorium, starting at 7 o'clock.

Junior writer
Lee Do-Yeop

Winter Overcoat:
Uniform Regulation or Students' Health?



"The mornings are the coldest," a freshman complains. "I start my mornings with a cold shiver down my spine." This probably is the case for many students at 6:30 AM, making their trembling way to morning exercise. One thing that makes it bearable is the parkas that students are allowed to wear during morning exercise. "The morning cold would have been unbearable if we had to wear our school overcoats to the gym, when the only thing we can wear under our Taekwondo uniform is a thin T-shirt," rhe freshman says.

In March, there were twenty days below zero degrees, and KMLA does not let its beautiful but chilly snow melt. Students participating in archery are forced to practice inside during this time of the year, as they cannot wear parkas when shooting and the chill is unbearable without them.

The problem is that the school outercoat is too thin to suffice. Being at least a third thinner than personal parkas, they don't seem to be doing much good of a job in warming bodies. Its thinness is perfect for a breezy fall day, but not for a snowy, freezing winter. Knowing the difficulties of creating a school overcoat, other high schools have already permitted the wearing of personal parkas outside their school uniforms. KMLA remains to be the one of the few schools that obliges students to wear only school coats in all cases.

The reasons for the strict school policy are quite acceptable because it blurs the intention of school uniforms in the first place, and it moreover leads to competition and peer pressure to wear expensive and luxurious overcoats. Yet let us compare this tangible benefit to how the students' right to health is violated. Some students shiver the entire day while wearing their school overcoats. Some suffer from a cold due to this cold. In these cases, much responsibility lies in the hands of the school, being the entity to prevent them from wearing warmer clothes. In many cases, personal overcoats are not worn for fashion nor differentiating oneself from others. It is worn for utility purposes, especially when Hoengsong weather is deadly cold, and students travel a whole lot more outside compared to other high school students. If this is the case, it would be warming, both physically and emotionally, if the school was to be more considerate towards the freezing students in their thin outwears.

"The students hope for a more open-minded policy from the school."

If the school's strict policy cannot but force students to wear the school outercoat, it must, at least, allow students to wear something over their school outercoat. If mufflers are allowed, gloves are allowed, and hats are allowed, why can't a simple coat be? Furthermore, the change in our uniform, which will take place this summer, can be the perfect opportunity to provide the students with a better school overcoat. The new uniform has addressed many issues that were bothering the students, such as high cost and design. Though these new changes are surely necessary and looked forward to, the problem of winter overcoat must be the first problem the school must solve, as it is directly correlated with students' health. Until this change comes, the school should consider the option of allowing personal coat over uniform, regardless of which season it is. The students hope for a more open-minded policy from the school.

Junior writer
Oh Yoon-Jin

Humans of Minsa



20th waver Kim So-Hee is a member of the Humans of Minsa. Instead of being the interviewer, she took the opportunity to sit at the other side of the table and tell her own story.

Since I was young, I've envied friends who had specific dreams. Perhaps it was because my dream changed quite often. For example, when my mother said that since I like animals, I could be a vet, my dream was to be a vet; when my aptitude test said that my aptitudes were suited for a patent attorney, it became my dream. Those days, I decided on my dreams without considering that much about it.

Then, someday, I realized that the question I wanted to answer was not "What is your dream?" but "How do you want to live?." And there certainly was an answer to that question. I can live only once, so I want to live for others. I believe living this way will make me happy. This is why volunteering is my ultimate goal and the reason of my life. Since then, I've been telling people that I want to live my life for others.

Though I still envy friends who have specific goals, now I have the feeling that at least, I have a dream I can follow through my life. That's probably why I didn't fix myself in one area, since my dreams were not very clear. I did whatever I thought was consistent with my values, and could make my heart beat.

I still don't have a short-term goal. If I had to put it into words, I would say that my dream is to work for an international organization. That's because I always consider myself a frog in a well. I once thought that when I entered high school I'd come out of the well, but it seems like I'm still in one. I want to see the world in a broader perspective. On a side note, I think this is also why I like to write. Thoughts aren't confined. They're free, aren't they? And writing can express them quite well, although somewhat limitedly.

All credit of the photo and interview goes to Humans of Minsa.

Annual Minjok Herald Literary Competition

Every year, Minjok Herald opens a Literary Competition for the freshmen. The competition invites all students, not only Minjok Herald writers, to show off their amazing works, and helps share the excitement of writing. The winner is given the privilege of being published on the year's first Minjok Herald. This year, the freshmen were asked to write a piece of literature, choosing out of three prompts.

Prompt: Chose one of the following topics

1. YOLO
2. Revolution
3. Howling

In this edition of the Minjok Herald, we introduce the winner's writing by...

Jung Seo-Lyn



Witnessed: Howling in the Distance

Someone screams in the distance. It's definitely female. I put on my headphones and turn on the music, trying my best to shut it out. It's no use. The screaming has turned into something more like howling, more desperate, and now I have no choice but to stop the music since it's getting unbearable.

I'm petrified. I don't know if I should get out of here as fast as I can, or go and comfort her. Either way, I have to stop listening to this.

I quickly discover I have two major problems, which is a) I don't have anywhere else to go anyway and b) this could be dangerous.

I don't know why I'm doing this. I'm unintentionally dragged to the source of the screaming when –

Next thing I know I break into a run, my backpack hitting me repeatedly on the back. After running for a few seconds, I slip my bag off my shoulder and throw it somewhere near a tree. I don't know. I don't –

Why am I running like this? Why can't I stop, I'm out of breath and yet I'm not stopping, and the girl can't stop crying –

Please stop crying –

I stop. My knees are shaking uncontrollably. I hold on to them, and look around. I must be somewhere in the forest. There's nothing but trees around me, and the sky's pitch black. Every time I move or breathe, the forest responds with an eerie howl. One thing I know, it's someplace far from civilization. There's a sickening feeling in my stomach as I realize nobody will know where I am. Then I try to remember what I am doing here. I vaguely remember the howling, the screaming, the crying. I look up.

It's a girl. The girl, leaning against an old pine tree, looks no older than fifteen years old, which is much younger than I expected. Judging by the state of her clothes, she's been living out here for a while.

I look at her, and she looks back at me. She doesn't look surprised that I'm here. Instead, she stares at me like she's lonely, like she wants me to join her and sit with her.

I try to ignore my heart that's beating madly. I try to ignore the little voice in my head that screams, get out of here, get out, get out –

Unfortunately, I succeed.

My phone starts to ring. The little girl jumps in surprise and I quickly turn it off. It's my mother again. She's been calling me for hours since I stumbled into this forest. But today she seems about the most unimportant person to deal with right now. The girl's glaring at my phone in either fear or angst, and I'm careful to avoid her eyes.

I take out the battery, and my phone dies.

Probably from screaming so hard, the girl breathes almost too heavily. She has a deranged look on her, the look someone has when they're close to death and doesn't want it. I try to scoot as far away from her as possible. But I go like a few centimeters and she whips her head around and looks at me with an expression that makes my hair rise.

I start to shake.

Why am I not calling for help? Why can't I leave when I have the absolute freedom to? I can't even stare at her. There's something wrong about her, and though I can't place it, it's giving me the chills.

Minutes pass. Hours. We sit next to each other, not even acknowledging each other's presence. I sit helpless knowing there's nobody to call for help. This girl seems to have no intention to leave the tree she's leaning against. My hands are in my pocket the whole time, gripping my phone, turning it over and over…

I think I see a set of eyes. They're wide, like a cat's, but the pupils are wide and round, and then I realize it's an owl. It's been with us the whole time, the owl. Why didn't I notice it before?

A few more minutes pass in total silence. The owl doesn't leave the branch it's been sitting on. It doesn't even do anything; it's just sitting there. Do owls usually do that?

The owl then screeches.

The girl moves for the first time since I've seen her. She looks up at the owl.

Without looking away, she reaches in her pocket and takes out a small bottle. She slowly turns the lid, and it's taking her so long it looks like she's doing it reluctantly. Like someone's behind her and threatening her to open it. She puts her hand in and pulls out something, which I can't see because it's too dark. Then she opens her mouth.

I scream. But it's too late.

The owl leaves the branch and flies away into the dark night.

> "Fairy tales are more than true: not because they tell us that dragons exist, but because they tell us that dragons can be beaten."
>
> - Neil Gaiman, Coraline

